

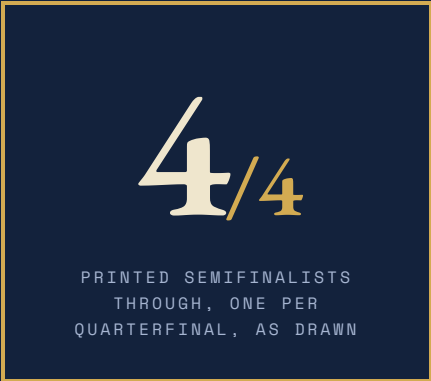
THE QUARTERFINAL CHECKPOINT

Four printed winners, and the *exact* semifinals.

GYAN called the winner of all four quarterfinals, and the four teams it printed into the semifinals before a ball was kicked are the four teams standing in July. France vs Spain and England vs Argentina are not just plausible pairings the model liked. They are the exact matchups on page 4 of the printed bracket.

A square box with a thin yellow border. Inside, the text '4/4' is displayed in a large, white, serif font. The '4' is white, and the '/' and the second '4' are yellow. Below this, in a smaller white sans-serif font, is the text: 'QUARTERFINAL WINNER CALLS, GYAN'S FIRST PERFECT KNOCKOUT ROUND'.

QUARTERFINAL WINNER CALLS,
GYAN'S FIRST PERFECT
KNOCKOUT ROUND

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PRINTED SEMIFINALISTS
THROUGH, ONE PER
QUARTERFINAL, AS DRAWN

A square box with a thin yellow border. Inside, the text '2/2' is displayed in a large, white, serif font. The '2' is white, and the '/' and the second '2' are yellow. Below this, in a smaller white sans-serif font, is the text: 'EXACT SEMIFINAL MATCHUPS, CALLED MONTHS IN ADVANCE'.

EXACT SEMIFINAL MATCHUPS,
CALLED MONTHS IN ADVANCE

01 • THE HEADLINE

The round where the page came true.

The quarterfinals ran July 9 to 11. France beat Morocco, Spain beat Belgium, England beat Norway, and Argentina beat Switzerland. All four winners are the teams GYAN printed into those bracket positions before the tournament, and the resulting semifinal draw, France vs Spain and England vs Argentina, matches GYAN's printed semifinal draw exactly. The stage scored **6 of 12 points (50.0%)**, the model's best knockout round yet, and the running Knockout Score moves to **37 of 84 (44.0%)**.

Everything the page still prints is alive: Spain over France, England over Argentina, a Spain vs England final, a France vs Argentina third-place match, and Spain lifting the trophy at **13.2%**.

02 • SOURCES AND SCORING

Same rules as every checkpoint.

Results and the semifinal draw come from FIFA's match centre, cross-checked against ESPN, Sky Sports, Yahoo Sports, FOX Sports, Al Jazeera, and Opta. All sources agree on every score and both semifinal pairings. Each completed match is worth up to 3 points:

+1 POINT**The winner call**

The team GYAN printed as the winner of that bracket position won the match.

+1 POINT**The exact matchup**

Both teams in the tie are the two teams GYAN drew, surviving every upstream reshuffle.

+1 BONUS**The perfect tie**

Both at once: right pairing, right winner. The hardest thing a printed bracket can do.

Four quarterfinals put 12 points on the table for the stage and lift the running knockout maximum from 72 to 84.

03 • THE QUARTERFINALS

Four matches, checked against the page.

GYAN's printed advancer was on the field in all four ties. Three faced a swapped opponent, one met the exact opponent it was drawn against, and all four advanced.

RESULT	DATE • VENUE	GYAN'S PRINTED TIE	VERDICT
 France 2-0  Morocco	THU JUL 9 • BOSTON	France vs Netherlands, France to win	WINNER CORRECT
 Spain 2-1  Belgium	FRI JUL 10 • LOS ANGELES	Spain vs Belgium, Spain to win	EXACT PAIR + WINNER
 England 2-1  Norway AET	SAT JUL 11 • MIAMI	Brazil vs England, England to win	WINNER CORRECT
 Argentina 3-1  Switzerland AET	SAT JUL 11 • KANSAS CITY	Argentina vs Portugal, Argentina to win	WINNER CORRECT

4/4 WINNER CALLS • 100%	1/4 EXACT MATCHUPS • SPAIN VS BELGIUM	1/4 PERFECT TIES • SPAIN OVER BELGIUM	6/12 STAGE POINTS • 50.0%, BEST ROUND YET
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Scorers, for the record. France: Mbappe 60, Dembele 66. Spain: F. Ruiz 30, Merino 88, with De Ketelaere 41 for Belgium. England: Bellingham 45+2 and 93, with Schjelderup 36 for Norway. Argentina: Mac Allister 10, Alvarez 112, Lautaro Martinez 120+1, with Ndoye 67 for Switzerland. England and Argentina were both level at 1-1 after ninety minutes and won in extra time.

04 • WHAT STOOD OUT

Reading the round honestly.

A perfect round on winner calls deserves both the credit and the caveats. Here is what the quarterfinals actually said about the model.

The winner engine did not blink.

Four printed winners, four semifinal places, GYAN's first knockout round with zero failed winner calls. It was not a stroll: England and Argentina both needed extra time after sitting level at 1-1 through ninety minutes. But for the first time since the knockouts began, nothing the model printed as a winner lost.

The swapped-opponent pattern is now 16 of 16, caveats attached.

Whenever GYAN's printed winner has faced a different opponent than the one it was drawn against, it has won: 10 of 10 in the Round of 32, 3 of 3 in the Round of 16, and now 3 of 3 in the quarterfinals (France over Morocco, England over Norway, Argentina over Switzerland). The honest reading stays the same: it is a small sample that mostly tracks favorites beating the teams that upset their printed opponents, and two of the three quarterfinal cases needed extra time to land. A tendency with a perfect record is still a tendency, not a law.

Spain vs Belgium went exactly to the page.

The one quarterfinal GYAN drew as an exact pairing produced the printed winner, the report's only perfect tie of the round. One scratch on the script: De Ketelaere's 41st-minute goal was the first Spain conceded all tournament. The printed champion is still unbeaten, but no longer spotless.

Brazil remains the model's only true knockout miss.

Across 25 knockout matches in which GYAN's printed advancer took the field, only Brazil has lost inside 120 minutes. The other two misses, Germany and the Netherlands, both fell in penalty shootouts after 1-1 draws. Every printed pick that reached the quarterfinals delivered.

05 • THE SEMIFINAL DRAW

GYAN has predicted the exact semifinal matchups of the 2026 World Cup.

The printed field went 13 of 16 at the Round of 16 and 5 of 8 at the quarterfinals, then snapped back to 4 of 4 at the semifinals. The three quarterfinalists GYAN never printed into the last eight, Morocco, Norway, and Switzerland, were each eliminated by the printed semifinalist occupying their pathway. GYAN's four semifinalists are also its top four on the champion board, so the model's strength read and its bracket read now agree with the tournament.

SEMIFINAL 1 • EXACT MATCHUP, AS PRINTED

TUE JUL 14 • DALLAS

 France

VS

 Spain

GYAN's printed tie: France vs Spain • **Spain to win**

EXACT MATCHUP

SEMIFINAL 2 • EXACT MATCHUP, AS PRINTED

WED JUL 15 • ATLANTA

 England

VS

 Argentina

GYAN's printed tie: England vs Argentina • **England to win**

EXACT MATCHUP

THE PRINTED ENDGAME, STILL FULLY ALIVE

SEMIFINALS Spain & England <i>printed winners of the last four</i>	THE FINAL Spain vs England <i>printed title match, Jul 19</i>	THIRD PLACE France vs Argentina <i>printed as a 2022 final rematch</i>	CHAMPION Spain • 13.2% <i>two wins from a clean page</i>
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06 • THE KNOCKOUT SCORE

Three rounds on the board.

The composite runs on the same three layers as always: winner calls, exact matchups, and perfect-tie bonuses, out of 3 points per match.

STAGE	WINNER CALLS	EXACT MATCHUPS	PERFECT TIES	POINTS
Round of 32	13/16	5/16	3/16	21/48 43.8%
Round of 16	5/8	3/8	2/8	10/24 41.7%
Quarterfinals	4/4	1/4	1/4	6/12 50.0%
Total	22/28 78.6%	9/28	6/28	37/84 44.0%

78.6%

KNOCKOUT WINNER CALLS • 22 OF 28

88.0%

WHERE THE PRINTED ADVANCER WAS IN THE TIE • 22 OF 25

44.0%

COMPOSITE KNOCKOUT SCORE • 37 OF 84

How to read the composite. The winner-call layer keeps strengthening: 22 of 28 knockout matches have gone to the team the bracket printed, and better than seven in eight where GYAN's printed advancer actually took the field. The exact-matchup and perfect-tie layers stay strict by design, because a single printed bracket has to survive every upstream reshuffle to land a pairing, and they hold the composite at 44.0%.

Same lesson as every checkpoint so far: the model reads team strength well, and the printed page pays the price of being one snapshot of a 100,000-run distribution. This round, for once, the snapshot and the distribution agreed.

07 · TAKEAWAYS GOING INTO THE SEMIFINALS

Two results from a *clean page*.

1 A perfect quarterfinal round on winner calls.

Four of four printed winners advanced. GYAN's knockout winner record now reads 22 of 28 (78.6%), and 22 of 25 (88.0%) where its printed pick was actually in the tie.

2 The semifinals are GYAN's printed semifinals, exactly.

France vs Spain in Dallas and England vs Argentina in Atlanta, both drawn on page 4 of the bracket document months before the tournament. Semifinal field 4 of 4, matchups 2 of 2.

3 Nothing about the model's endgame has been eliminated.

Printed semifinal winners, printed final, printed third-place match, and printed champion all remain fully in play. Spain at 13.2% needs two more wins for the page to run clean to the trophy.

4 Credit and caveats travel together.

The swapped-opponent pattern is 16 of 16, but two of this round's three cases needed extra time, and small samples mostly track favorites winning. The bracket is having a very good tournament. The probabilities are why.

NEXT CHECKPOINT

After the final, when the last four printed calls, Spain over France, England over Argentina, France third, and Spain champion, are settled and the full-tournament review can be written.